# DCTVU

## DC TELEVISION UNIVERSE

Franchise Bible — Volume 04: Leadership & Studios

**FORMAT • TONE • CONTINUITY • CANON • TEAMS & FOUNDING ROSTERS**

An alternate-history story told through Hollywood trades, headlines,
social media, the internet, and screenplay-format scenes.

Story present: 2010.
Six live-action series + two animated series. One multiverse.

Internal development document. Fictional actors and the individual series to be created in later volumes.

# Section 1 — The Person Who Spearheads the DCTVU

**GEOFF JOHNS** — **Chief Creative Officer, DC Entertainment** (real-world appointment announced Feb. 18, 2010), and in our story also **Head of the DCTVU and Chair of the DCTVU Story Group**, with an executive producer credit on every live-action and animated series.

Born **January 25, 1973**: age **36** on Jan. 1, 2010, and **37** from Jan. 25, 2010.

**Why Johns.** The DCTVU has two non-negotiables: 100% comic accuracy and nobody nerfed. Johns is the one executive in 2010 who is also one of DC's defining writers. His *Green Lantern*, *The Flash*, *JSA*, *Teen Titans*, and *Blackest Night* runs rebuilt the modern DC Universe, and he wrote and produced on *Smallville* ("Legion," "Absolute Justice"), so he already knows how DC works on broadcast television. Making him franchise head gives the canon a guardian with authority. Every arc, power level, costume, and death goes through his Story Group.

## Franchise leadership structure

| Role | Person | Responsibility |
|---|---|---|
| Head of the DCTVU / Story Group Chair | Geoff Johns (CCO, DC Entertainment) | Canon, continuity, the Master Timeline, the multiverse map, final creative say on all series |
| Franchise Architect / Executive Producer, all live-action | Greg Berlanti (overall deal, Warner Bros. Television). Born May 24, 1972: age 37 on Jan. 1, 2010; 38 from May 24, 2010. | Television craft, building the series, choosing showrunners, crossover production |
| Studio executive | Peter Roth, President, Warner Bros. Television (real-world) | Studio deals, budgets, network sales |
| Corporate | Diane Nelson, President, DC Entertainment (real-world) | Brand and business oversight |

**Why pair Johns with Berlanti:** Johns protects the source material, and Berlanti knows how to make network drama work. In 2010 Berlanti has created *Everwood* and *Brothers & Sisters*, co-created *Eli Stone*, is launching ABC's superhero drama *No Ordinary Family*, and is co-writing Warner Bros.' *Green Lantern* film. Neither one alone covers both halves of the job.

# Section 2 — Who Leads Each Series

These picks are matched to each series' role in the slate (flagship, spinoff, separate Earth, ensemble, and so on). Once you create the series' concepts, we can adjust any pairing. Johns and Berlanti are executive producers on all eight.

| Series | Developer / showrunner | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Live-Action 1 (2012–2020) — flagship | **Greg Berlanti & Marc Guggenheim** (co-creators); **Andrew Kreisberg** (co-creator / co-showrunner) | The flagship needs the franchise architect. Guggenheim is a DC and Marvel comics writer who co-wrote the *Green Lantern* film with Berlanti. Kreisberg has comics writing credits and genre TV experience. |
| Live-Action 2 (2014–2023) — first spinoff | **Andrew Kreisberg** (showrunner), co-created with Berlanti & Geoff Johns | Kreisberg moves up from LA1 to give the first spinoff a showrunner who already knows the shared universe, and Johns co-creates it so the spinoff is built to canon from day one. |
| Live-Action 3 (2015–2021) — CBS launch, separate Earth | **Ali Adler** (co-creator / showrunner), with Berlanti & Kreisberg | Adler has big-network experience on *Chuck* and *Glee*, which fits a CBS launch, and her strong character-driven voice lets the show stand alone on its own Earth before it crosses over. |
| Live-Action 4 (2016–2022) — ensemble spinoff | **Phil Klemmer** (showrunner), with Berlanti, Guggenheim & Kreisberg | Klemmer ran ensembles on *Chuck* and *Veronica Mars*. A spinoff that gathers characters from LA1 and LA2 needs someone who can juggle a big cast. |
| Live-Action 5 (2018–2021) — own Earth, joins in S3 | **Salim Akil & Mara Brock Akil** (developers / showrunners) | *Girlfriends* and *The Game*. A distinct, authorial voice suits a series that begins on its own Earth with its own tone. |
| Live-Action 6 (2019–2022) | **Caroline Dries** (developer / showrunner) | She wrote for *Smallville* and later ran *The Vampire Diaries* for The CW, so she has DC experience and knows The CW. |
| Animated 1 (2015–2016) | **Bruce Timm** (executive producer / supervising producer), with **Andrea Romano** (casting and voice director); Kreisberg as live-action liaison | Timm is the architect of the DC Animated Universe (*Batman: TAS*, *Superman: TAS*, *Justice League*), the gold standard for faithful DC animation. Born Feb. 8, 1961: age 48 on Jan. 1, 2010; 49 from Feb. 8, 2010. |
| Animated 2 (2017–2018) — parallel Earth | **Bruce Timm** (executive producer), with **Alan Burnett** (story editor); Guggenheim as live-action liaison | Burnett co-built the DC Animated Universe with Timm, and the two have the multiverse expertise a parallel-Earth series needs. |

**Accuracy note for later timeline entries:** Birthdays recorded so far: Johns, Berlanti, and Timm (above); Guggenheim (Sept. 24, 1970); Kreisberg (Feb. 20, 1971). Still to be confirmed: the birthdays of Ali Adler, Phil Klemmer, Salim Akil, Mara Brock Akil, Caroline Dries, Andrea Romano, and Alan Burnett They'll be confirmed before any of them appears in a dated, age-stamped story entry, so every age stays accurate.

# Section 3 — The Studios

**LIVE-ACTION: WARNER BROS. TELEVISION**, in association with **DC Entertainment** and **Berlanti Productions**.
**ANIMATION: WARNER BROS. ANIMATION**, in association with **DC Entertainment**.

| Studio | Role | Why it's the right choice |
|---|---|---|
| Warner Bros. Television | Produces all six live-action series | DC's corporate sibling under Time Warner. It already produces *Smallville*, has Vancouver crews and VFX vendors, and co-owns The CW. It can also produce for CBS (LA3, Season 1), so one studio handles the whole live-action franchise and the move to The CW is seamless. |
| DC Entertainment | Co-producer; canon authority | Owns the characters. Johns's Story Group operates from here, and DC signs off on accuracy, costumes, and power levels. |
| Berlanti Productions | Production company on all live-action series | Berlanti's company is the franchise's hands-on production engine and its source of showrunners. |
| Warner Bros. Animation | Produces both animated series | Home of the DC Animated Universe, Timm, Burnett, and Romano. It supplies Cartoon Network and handles crossover animation alongside the live-action series. |

## Production base

- **Vancouver, British Columbia** for all live-action series. It's Smallville's established home, it offers Canadian tax credits, and shared stages, crews, and VFX vendors make crossovers cheaper and easier to schedule.
- **LA3 Season 1 (CBS)** shoots in Los Angeles on the network's bigger budget, then moves to Vancouver with the switch to The CW. That's a realistic, cost-driven move the 2016 trades would cover.
- **Warner Bros. Animation, Burbank** for both animated series, with a voice cast that includes the live-action actors whenever their characters appear.